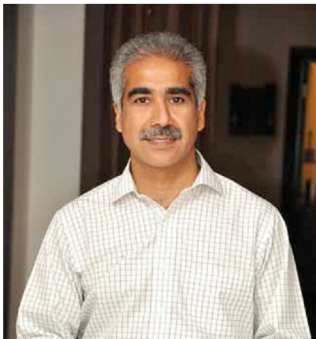


“Samsung tweaks Android to enhance the user experience”

After the immensely successful Galaxy Tab 2 series, Samsung has launched its successor—the Galaxy Tab 3 devices—in the Indian market. The company is well aware that the Android platform can take it places. Hence, it is banking on it in a big way. With these devices, the company promises to offer an all-new Android experience to users in India. In an exclusive tête-à-tête with **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You**, **Vineet Taneja**, country head, **Mobile & IT, Samsung India** talked on topics ranging from how the company is playing with Android, to the Samsung Galaxy S4, stock Android, Windows Phone, et al. Excerpts:



Vineet Taneja, country head, Mobile & IT, Samsung India

Q: A lot of tablet makers are now targeting the enterprise and education segments. Can you share your strategy for this market?

Apart from those who just want to buy tabs, there are two segments of users who are approaching us in a big way. One is the institutions that want to buy tabs and include them as a part of their enrolment kit. The second segment comprises people who have education content to offer. A lot of education content providers are reaching out to us to offer their content on our tablets, to attract students. We believe that a tablet

PC is a great device for students. You still need a laptop for heavy-duty computing but when it comes to consumption of content, for which the user wants to surf the Internet on-the-go or to read an e-book, a tablet is the perfect device. We understand from the market that if we can offer good content on the tablet, there will be more takers for the devices.

On the enterprise side, the tendency is for companies to customise their own solutions. Some of the enterprises have started using tablets for their field force, including their sales and marketing guys, where the devices are used as an aid in selling products or services to their customers. So overall, I think there is enough traction from both the education and enterprise segments.

Q: Do you offer special pricing for the education segment?

A: We do not give any subsidy as such, but we do have several offers including the EMI scheme to help students buy our devices. In cases of a B2B deal, when an institution is placing a bulk order, it does get special pricing.

Q: A majority of data usage is via smartphones and laptops. How do you plan to drive data usage with these tablets?

A: Our job is not to grow data. That is the consequence of using a device. But I can say that the larger the screen, the better the data consumption. So a tablet is a great device to drive data consumption from an operator's perspective, which is why we partner with the operators. In the case of Samsung Galaxy Tab 3, we have joined hands with Vodafone.

Q: If you look at the current market, there are smartphones in the range of 14.7 cm (5.8 inch)- 16 cm (6.3-inch) screen sizes. Don't you think they are a challenge to the 17.7 cm (7 inch) tablets?

A: The good thing is that it was us who created the 14.7 cm (5.8